Minutes for the March 11, 2026 Vietnam Veterans of America, Chapter 279 Meeting

The regular meeting of Chapter 279 was called to order by President Hester at 1830 hours on Wednesday, March 11, 2026. After the salute to the American Flag, President Hester led the Chapter in the Pledge of Allegiance. Chaplain Dwain Holmes led the Chapter in prayer. His email is tukupholmes@gmail.com. His phone number is: 402-999-1108. This is helpful to him—please put in your contact list.

Roll call of officers: President Terry Hester, Vice President Joe Mangiamelli, Secretary Tom Halbkat, and Treasurer Ron Haase. There are 4 officers present and 32 members present. We have a quorum.

Nomination of offers: Tom Brown

Guest Speaker: None

New Members: None

Sick Call: Ron Dupell, Jim Kjosa, Rich Shivley, and Larry Meeky. Hurry back guys—we miss you.

President's Report: Quilts of Valor Ceremony will be held on Saturday, March 28 at 5pm, honoring four of our chapter members. Please wear your white uniform. This will be your last call if your plan to attend the Vietnam Veterans Day and the Quilts of Valor Ceremony. Bring your spouse. I need to know the count for the American Legion of the people attending by March 11. Email rterryhester@cox.net. Four of our members will be presenting the colors before the ceremony. The Foundation is having a Vietnam Veterans ceremony on Sunday, March 29th at 2pm. The location is at the Papillion Landing, 1046 W. Lincoln Street. We need four members to present the Colors. Pete Gill made a motion that the chapter donate $250.00 to the foundation, second by Sid Howard. Motion passed. Our annual golf outing is set for Sept. 28th, 2026, it our 11th annual. Get fired up, guys and gals. This is our money maker for the year. We have 3 parades scheduled so far, Elkhorn—May 30th, Papillion—June 20th, and Ralston—July 4th. We also had a funeral for a chapter member, Dick Hays. All nominations for officers will cease on opening of April meeting. Pete Gill made a motion giving the present officers a vote of confidence. Dave Francos seconded and motion passed.

Secretary Report: Report was emailed to all members. George Abbott moved to accept the report as written and Glen Page seconded. Motion carried.

Treasurer Report: Treasurer Haase gave a very exclusive look at our chapter funds, including budgets to 2032. Our CD and money market funds were explained carefully. We had 3 bills that needed paying. Information board for Quilt display—64.95, ½ of storage shed rental—470.00, website work—100. Tom Brown moved we pay the bills and Bill Wagoner seconded. Motion passed. Anthony Weathers moved to accept the treasurer report and David Teer seconded. Motion passed.

Scholarships: None

Veterans Home Board: None

Correspondence Report: Joe Mangiamellia reported that the Governor will speak March 27th to honor the VVA in Nebraska.

National VVA Delegate Report: Dottie Barickman will give a more extensive report next month.

Nebraska VVA Foundation: No report

Homeless Veterans: No report

Chapter Membership Report: 221 members and 12 associates

POW/MIA: Still stands at 1566

Old or new business:

Please check out the chapter's webpage: nebraskavietnamveterans.com

Closing Prayer: Chaplain Holmes

Next meeting: April 8, 2026 at 1830 hours, at the American Legion Post 374

Motion to adjourn made by Ed Boller and seconded by Mike Steffen. Motion passed.

Submitted by:

Tom Halbkat, Secretary